Arjun Deshmukh

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Education

University of Southern California — Los Angeles, CA
Master of Science in Financial Engineering GPA: 3.41 / 4.0 — *May 2026*
- Coursework: Financial Analytics, Probability, Quantitative Investing, Capital Markets, Investments and Portfolio Management

NMIMS University — Mumbai, India
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Business Systems GPA: 3.40 / 4.0 — *May 2024*
- Coursework: Artificial Intelligence, Data Mining, Algorithms, Cloud Enterprise Microservices, Business Strategy and Economics

Experience

Cogitative Investments, Asset Management — San Diego, CA
Investment Analyst — *Jul 2026 – Present*
- Corrected cash-on-cash returns from −0.42% to 6.25% and 15.22% to 11.40% by standardizing post-debt cash flow and invested equity calculations.
- Established monthly reporting for 3 properties with $166K invested equity, analyzing operating, financing, and timing variances against forecasts.
- Consolidated 4 spreadsheets into 1 driver-based quarterly forecast linking rental income, occupancy, expenses and debt supporting capital allocation.

Easley-Dunn Productions, Inc. — Torrance, CA
Financial Analyst — *Jun 2026 – Jul 2026*
- Compared pricing across 3 markets by comparing FX conversion with volatility-based regional price bands, balancing affordability and monetization.
- Evaluated inflation risk and proposed pricing changes in a dual-currency economy using Python, Monte Carlo simulations, and regression.
- Built biweekly and monthly KPI dashboards tracking currency creation, consumption, monetization, and retention to inform pricing reviews.

Internships

UTI Alternatives, Alternative Investment Fund — New Delhi, India
Private Equity and Structured Credit Intern — *Jul 2025 – Sep 2025*
- Screened 4 private investment opportunities totaling $5M across financial services, real estate, and education, with 1 advancing to term sheet.
- Assessed school expansion debt capacity across 3 scenarios, linking enrollment, tuition collections, staffing, DSCR and collateral coverage.
- Aligned milestone-based funding and repayments by stress-testing expansion plans of school facilities against breakeven targets of the fund.

HDFC Securities, Broking and Investment Advisory — Mumbai, India
Trading and Product Strategy Intern — *May 2025 – Jul 2025*
- Identified product gaps across Zerodha, Kotak, and Axis by comparing onboarding, research, trading, and margin access, informing product priorities.
- Benchmarked collateral haircuts across 25 common equities, separating haircut rates from pledge eligibility to ensure like-for-like comparisons.
- Proposed tiered haircuts and a separate MTF leverage increase from 2.5x toward 3x for securities, balancing capital efficiency with collateral risk.

Yes Bank Limited, Banking and Financial Services — Mumbai, India
Business Analyst Intern — *May 2023 – Jul 2023*
- Automated 2 monthly incentive plans for 1,000+ employees and 25+ business rules using SQL and Python, retaining Excel reporting.
- Cut reporting turnaround to T+1 by consolidating sales performance, KPI attainment, payouts, variance analysis, and what-if scenarios.
- Delivered automated plans and structured roadmaps supporting a 130-plan automation strategy and employee incentives KPI dashboard.

Aditya Birla Capital, Financial Services — Mumbai, India
Investments and Equity Research Intern — *Jun 2022 – Jul 2022*
- Prioritized healthcare after comparing 3 sectors (BFSI, Defence, and Healthcare) on revenue visibility, cyclicality, and operating fundamentals.
- Shortlisted 2 of 20 healthcare companies through financial screening and hospital operating models across base, upside, and downside cases.
- Recommended KIMS and Rainbow Children's Medicare, which then outperformed the Sensex by 26 and 58 percentage points over one year.

Projects and Leadership

CampusX, Student Marketplace | *Finance, Strategy* — *Aug 2024 – Nov 2025*
- Co-founded a marketplace with 5,470 registrations and built financial models to track burn rate, unit economics, capital allocation.
- Identified fee generation from 164 transactions and focused on KPIs like paid conversion, take rate, and repeat usage.

Buy/Sell Trading Signal Engine | *Artificial Intelligence, Finance* — *Aug 2025 – Jan 2026*
- Built a signal engine scoring 118 equities across 11 sectors on a 0–100 scale using trend, momentum, volume, and NLP-based news sentiment.
- Backtested signals across rolling out-of-sample periods displaying buy, hold, and sell recommendations with underlying indicators.

CVaR-Based Left-Tail Factor Strategy | *Quantitative Investing* — *Aug 2025 – Nov 2025*
- Built a beta-neutral long-short equity strategy using rolling 252-day CVaR at the 5% tail threshold on CRSP data.
- Evaluated factor predictive power and risk-adjusted returns using Fama–MacBeth and Fama–French regressions.
- Tested robustness across lookback windows, tail thresholds, and bull and crisis market regimes.

Skills and Interests

Technical: Python, SQL, Excel, Tableau, Power BI, Financial Valuation and Modeling, FP&A, Anaplan, Forecasting, DCF, Variance Analysis
Certifications: Bloomberg Concepts, JPMC Job Simulation, Anthropic AI Fluency Certifications, Financial Modeling & Python skills by CFA
Languages: English, Hindi, Marathi, Punjabi
Interests: Active Investing, Market-Trend Analysis, Competitive Chess, Cricket, Poker, Films and TV (Thriller and Crime)